The Longevity Project

The new luxury is not living longer; it's living better.

BY KAMAYANI KANWAR





India's life expectancy is currently estimated at around 72 years. But there is another number I find far more interesting: the WHO's latest estimate, which puts India's healthy life expectancy at only 58.1 years. In other words, the real longevity conversation isn't simply about 'How long will we live?' Instead, it centres around, how many of those years will we remain strong, lucid, mobile, metabolically healthy, and independent?

That is where longevity becomes the new luxury. And it is not an attempt to remain 30 forever. It is the pursuit of arriving at 60, 70, 80, and beyond with as much muscle, curiosity, memory, independence, and joie de vivre intact as our biology will allow.

FOOD IS MEDICINE

If there is one longevity intervention accessible to almost everyone, it is food. We need variety: leafy greens, cruciferous vegetables, brightly coloured plants, herbs, berries, pomegranate, nuts, seeds, legumes, adequate protein, and healthy fats. Different colours provide different polyphenols and phytochemicals; rather than chasing one fashionable superfood, I encourage patients to eat the rainbow.

Demographic studies among longevity hotspots around the world predict shared broader patterns—plant-rich diets, regular movement, moderation and strong social relationships—although we should be careful not to pretend that any single "Blue Zone diet" has been empirically proven to enhance lifespan.

MUSCLE MATTERS

If people over 40 should protect one tissue aggressively, it's the muscle. It's not simply cosmetic but a metabolically active tissue that helps dispose of glucose, protects mobility, and physical independence, and is all the more precious as we age. Data now associates regular resistance training with lower all-cause, cardiovascular, and neurological mortality.

So lift weights. Squat. Carry things. Practise pilates or yoga for mobility. Walk whenever possible. And use one wonderfully simple metabolic hack: Move for 10–15 minutes after eating.